Diwakar Adhikari

thisisdwakr@gmail.com	+977-9843247059	Kathmandu-16, Nepal

Objective

Governance and development professional with 3+ years of experience supporting youth engagement, civic participation, and community-driven development initiatives in Nepal. Proven ability to work with local governments, civil society organizations, and youth networks to design and implement inclusive programmes, facilitate policy dialogue, and translate community voices into actionable governance outcomes. Strong background in results-based management (RBM), monitoring and evaluation, and the use of data and digital tools to support evidence-based decision-making. Experienced in working with marginalized communities, youth leaders, and municipal institutions across multiple provinces

Professional Experience

CONSULTANT | NEPAL PEACEBUILDING INITIATIVE

Project: Strengthening Policy-level and Grassroot Capacity to Enhance Climate Change Adaptation for Marginalized Communities (Feb 2025 – Jun 2025)

- Supported the design and implementation of community-based initiatives that strengthened civic participation and local ownership in climate adaptation planning.
- Conducted participatory civic engagement assessments with marginalized communities and youth groups, applying a practical GEDSI lens (who participates, whose voice is missing, barriers to access) to capture priorities and translate them into policy-relevant outputs
- Designed and delivered capacity-building sessions for 90+ youth leaders across six municipalities on advocacy, safe community outreach, and constructive engagement with local decision-makers
- Facilitated policy dialogue consultations with municipal and district officials to strengthen responsiveness of local plans to community-identified priorities and strengthen trust between citizens and institutions
- Coordinated between local governments, CSOs, and community representatives to ensure inclusive participation, manage expectations, and reduce governance gaps during implementation

PROGRAM OFFICER | CLEAN UP NEPAL

Multiple Projects and Campaigns (Dec 2018 - Feb 2022)

- Coordinated and led multi-municipality programme implementation, overseeing field staff, enumerators, and short-term consultants while strengthening citizen and youth engagement in local service delivery through structured outreach, grievance mechanisms, and collaboration with municipal counterparts

- Designed and implemented RBM/M&E systems (planning tools, indicators, data collection workflows) to track outputs, outcomes, and learning; contributed to evidence-based reporting for donors and government partners
- Worked with municipal governments, youth groups, waste workers, and civil society partners to operationalize inclusive participation, paying attention to GEDSI considerations in community consultations and training participation
- Advocated for policies that foster circular economy principles and sustainable practices into municipal operations, fostering systematic resource efficiency and reducing environmental impact
- Supported development and rollout of digital tools (web dashboard + mobile application) that enabled citizens, including young people, to report issues and support civic participation in local accountability processes
- Led capacity-building for enumerators, municipal staff, and community volunteers on survey ethics, community engagement, and use of digital platforms for citizen reporting
- Contributed to grant writing and resource mobilization, supporting the mobilization of approximately USD 100,000 for community-driven and data-informed initiatives

Selected Programme Achievements

- Coordinated household-level surveys covering ~70,000 households across six municipalities, strengthening local evidence for planning and decision-making.
- Supported training of 500+ municipal staff, waste workers, and community members (including youth participants) on participatory approaches, service delivery feedback loops, and data use.
- Delivered outreach and awareness campaigns reaching 30,000+ individuals, promoting public participation, accountability, and environmental rights

Consultancy

- *Recycling and Status of multilayered plastics in informal waste economy in Kathmandu Valley* | RIVER+ Project | People in Need Nepal (Feb 2024)
- *Mapping plastic recycling hubs, supply networks, and value chains in Kathmandu valley* |Urban Resilience Project | People in Need Nepal (May-Jun 2023)
- *A three-day workshop on "Establishing a community-driven governance system through Digital Waste Management System"* |CLEAN UP NEPAL (Jul 2022)

Research Work

RESEARCH FELLOW | Department of Botany, Tribhuvan University

Water-soil-food nexus and sustainable livelihoods through the mainstreaming of agrobiodiversity along the Marshyangdi River Basin, Gandaki Province, Nepal (October 2023 – September 2024)

- Supported evidence generation of climate change, water security, disaster risk reduction and livelihoods to inform local and provincial planning
- Conducted field-based assessments and community surveys engaging youth and marginalized households.
- Translated research findings to briefs, presentations, and inputs for stakeholder discussions

RESEARCH ASSISTANT | Research Centre for Applied Science and Technology

Assessment of Environmental Pollution at Sisdol Landfill Site and the Impact on the Livelihoods of the Nearby Communities (September 2023 – February 2024)

- Supported environmental assessment and community-level research around landfill and impacted area, documenting social and livelihoods implications for nearby communities

RESEARCH ASSISTANT | Kathmandu University

Karnali Water Activity Spring and Water Source Assessment (June 2022 - July 2022)

- Contributed to field assessment of spring and water resources, working with local stakeholders, capacity-building of enumerators and promoting citizen science stewardship

Key Skills

Project & Program Management

Project design, planning and execution, Stakeholder partnership management, Grant writing and fundraising, Monitoring and Evaluation, Budget Management, Expenditure Tracking, Program evaluation and reporting, Workshop and event coordination, Leadership and team management, Problem solving and innovation, Collaborative autonomy

Research, Data and Technical Expertise

Research and assessment, Literature Review, Geospatial software (ArcGIS and QGIS), Technical data analysis, Statistical software (Python, SPSS)

Communication, Advocacy & Engagement

Strategic content development, Campaigns design and implementation, Community outreach and mobilization, Environmental advocacy

Grant/Awards

- Research Fellowship, National Priority Research, Research Division Rector's Office, Tribhuvan University, October 2023
- Data Fellowship, Code for Nepal, July 2023
- Climate Action Fund, The Asia Foundation, September 2021
- Digital Solution Systems for Province 2, The Asia Foundation, March 2021
- Most Innovative Development Project (MIDP), Global Development Network, October 2021
- Small Asian Small Grant Project (SASGP), The Asia Foundation, December 2020

Education

Tribhuvan University (September 2021 - September 2024)

Central Department of Environmental Science | Kirtipur, Kathmandu

- **M.Sc. in Environmental Science**

Bachelors | Tribhuvan University (February 2014 – August 2018)

Tri-Chandra Multiple Campus | Saraswati Sadan, Jamal, Kathmandu

B.Sc. in Environmental Science